Clay holds water well but drains slowly after rain.
Adding compost each autumn loosens it over a few years.

Sandy beds dry out within a day of watering.
A mulch of leaves keeps the top layer damp in summer.

Earthworms were counted in a square of turned soil.
The composted bed had twice as many as the bare one.

Test the pH before liming, since most vegetables like it near neutral.
These notes will be updated after the next season.